

CLASSIFICATION AND PLACEMENT OF POSITIONS FOR THE UNIVERSAL SALARY SCALE

The universal salary scale applies to all employees currently assigned to those positions listed by job title on the universal salary scale and to any new positions assigned to the universal salary scale.

A. Generally.

1. Positions covered by the compensation plan are assigned to a level on the salary scale.
2. The School Board approves the universal salary scale as part of the budget process.
3. Special rate ranges may be established for certain classes of positions to meet labor market challenges. When it is determined that special rate ranges are no longer required, the positions assigned to such ranges shall return to their evaluated salary levels.
4. Determining classification level placement may include a job analysis. A job analysis may entail some or all of the following: a review of a written description of duties, a comparative ranking using objective measurement of job factors and/or a market analysis.

B. Initial Placement on the Salary Scale.

1. Initial placement of a new employee is determined by the Department of Human Resources and Talent Development and based on applicable full-time experience.
2. A former employee who left in good standing and who is re-employed may be placed at the same step equivalent to the employee's former step placement. Any additional experience gained after the employee left may also be considered in step placement.

C. Annual Step Increases.

1. Employees who have 12-month assignments and who have been employed on or before January 1, or the first workday thereafter, are eligible to receive a step increase in their salary for the next school year assignment.
2. Employees whose assignments are less than 12-months and who have been employed on or before the last working day of the first semester are eligible to receive a step increase in their salary for the next school year assignment.

CLASSIFICATION AND PLACEMENT OF POSITIONS FOR THE UNIVERSAL SALARY SCALE

3. Annual step increases are contingent upon funding.

4. Any employee who receives an unsatisfactory/unacceptable evaluation shall not receive a step increase in pay the next year if employment continues.

D. Step Placement Upon Reassignment or Transfer.

1. When an employee is reassigned or transferred to another position within the same level, no change is made in step placement on the salary scale.

2. When an employee is assigned to a position on a higher level, by reassignment, transfer, or reclassification of position, the employee's step placement will be determined based on relevant full-time experience and current placement practices.

3. An employee who accepts a lower level position because of reorganization or elimination of the employee's position will retain their current rate. However, if the employee's current rate exceeds the maximum rate of the new position, the employee's rate will be reduced to the maximum rate of the new position after one year in the new position. This does not apply to employees who are first offered a position of the same level or higher level but decline and subsequently accept a position of a lower level.

4. An employee in a position that has been downgraded will be placed at a step at the lower level that is nearest to the employee's current rate of pay without exceeding the employee's current rate of pay or, if the employee's current rate exceeds the maximum rate of the lower level, the employee's pay rate will be reduced within one year to the new maximum rate of the lower level.

5. An employee who accepts a position at a lower level voluntarily or as the result of a demotion will be placed on the same step at the lower level.

E. Temporary Assignment to Positions of Higher or Lower Level.

1. Employees who are assigned the full scope and duties of a higher level position on an interim or acting basis may be assigned a rate of the higher position.

The level of acting/interim position, step placement will be based on placement practices (minimum of 5% increase in daily rate for one level above their current position or a minimum of 10% increase in daily rate for two levels above their current position).

CLASSIFICATION AND PLACEMENT OF POSITIONS FOR THE UNIVERSAL SALARY SCALE

The Department of Human Resources and Talent Development will notify employees of this temporary assignment in writing. Upon returning to the regular assignment, the employee's salary shall revert to the former rate.

2. An employee assigned to perform work of a lower level will retain the employee's current rate.

F. Classification and Compensation Reviews.

1. Positions will be reviewed on a cyclical basis. Implementation of any changes is dependent upon funding approved through the budget process.

2. An off-cycle review may be requested by any member of senior staff, with approval by the appropriate Cabinet member, based upon organizational change, substantive repurposing of a role, and/or market conditions.

3. The Department of Human Resources and Talent Development will review the request to ensure that it meets the criteria for an off-cycle review. Requests that meet the criteria will be reviewed and a recommendation may be made to change the level of the position.

[Former Policy 7-54]

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